



Starship Troopers

Year: 1997

Director: Paul Verhoeven

A subtle and insidiously subversive film that examines a future society where military service dictates social hierarchy. As space marines take on an alien invasion of insect-like creatures, this iconic movie is your quintessential action film, with lots of explosions, and humanity-wins moments, with a deeper satire on fascism.



Independence Day

Year: 1996

Director: Roland Emmerich

Independence Day is the kind of alien-invasion film that needs to be seen on a massive screen with state-of-the-art surround sound. Over-the-top in every aspect (except the absurdly simplistic story), this movie is a visual and auditory treat that laid the foundation of pretty much every alien-invasion film to come.



A Brief History of Time

Author: Stephen Hawking

This is one of those rare books that manages to enrapture the regular reader as well as hardcore science fanatic at the same time. Almost everything you ever wanted to know about the universe is encapsulated in this one book with simplicity and elegance.



The Social Network

Year: 2010

Director: David Fincher

The story of Facebook's inception told through an exceptionally well written script by Aaron Sorkin. The movie manages to perfectly portray the cut-throat start-up culture and what it is like to be a geek on the cutting edge of web technology. As the tagline says, "You don't get to 500 million friends without making a few enemies".



The Day the Earth Stood Still

Year: 2008

Director: Scott Derrickson

A remake of the 1951 classic namesake, the movie is a forceful analysis of humanity and our nature, and the damage we have done to the planet in our wake. The movie, although nowhere near the original, is one worth watching simply for its scale and treatment.



Source Code

Year: 2011

Director: Duncan Jones

A movie that looks straightforward enough, but actually sucks you into its brilliant plot and concept. Source Code is intellectually stimulating enough for even the most hardcore geeks. Exploring the concept of parallel universes as a soldier attempts to stop a bomber before it's too late, this is a must-watch.



The Martian Chronicles

Author: Ray Bradbury

Written over half a century ago, this book focuses on real human and fictional Martian emotion, and what transpires when the two civilizations meet somewhere in 1999.



Limitless

Year: 2011

Director: Neil Burger

Few stars portray 'cool' as effortlessly as Bradley Cooper, and in this movie, he's at his best, playing a writer who discovers a top-secret drug that boosts his brain functions, giving him superhuman intelligence. Fantastic movie, with a snarky commentary on people addicted to pills and "performance enhancers".